

Culture and Civilisation Tradition

Arnold / F.R.
Leavis / Q.D.
Leavis

Marx and Marxism

Marx (Early and Mature)

Gramsci

Frankfurt School (Adorno /
Horkheimer)
Culture Industry
Benjamin
Habermas
Public Sphere

British Cultural Studies

Origins – Thompson / Williams
CCCS – Hoggart
Hall

Structuralism

Saussure
Sign / Signifier
Barthes
Mythologies

Jameson

MODERNISM

‘POST’

Intersectionality

Fraser (critique of
Public Sphere)

Post-modernism

Lyotard
Baudrillard

**Post-
structuralism**

Foucault

Feminism

First Wave
Second Wave

**Third Wave (post-
feminism)**

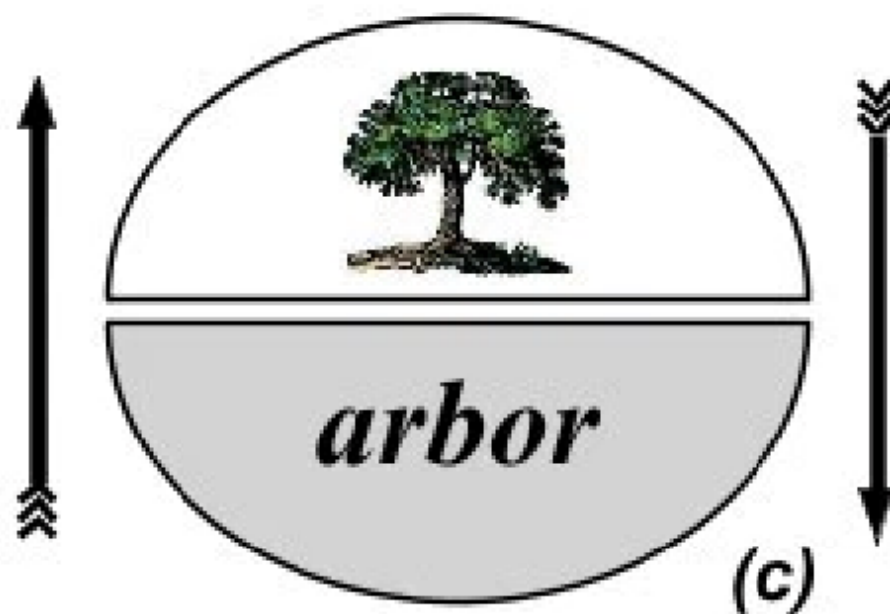
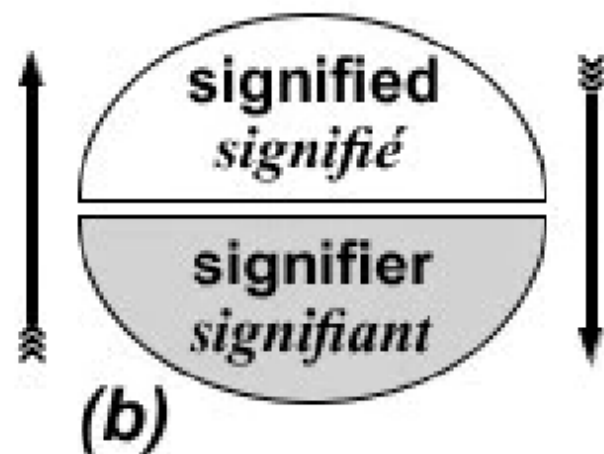
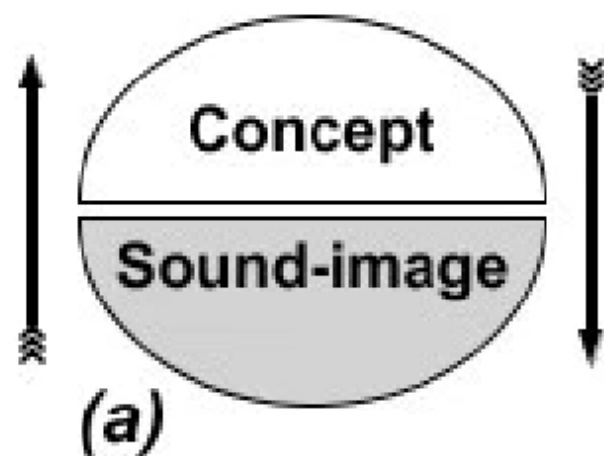
Queer Theory

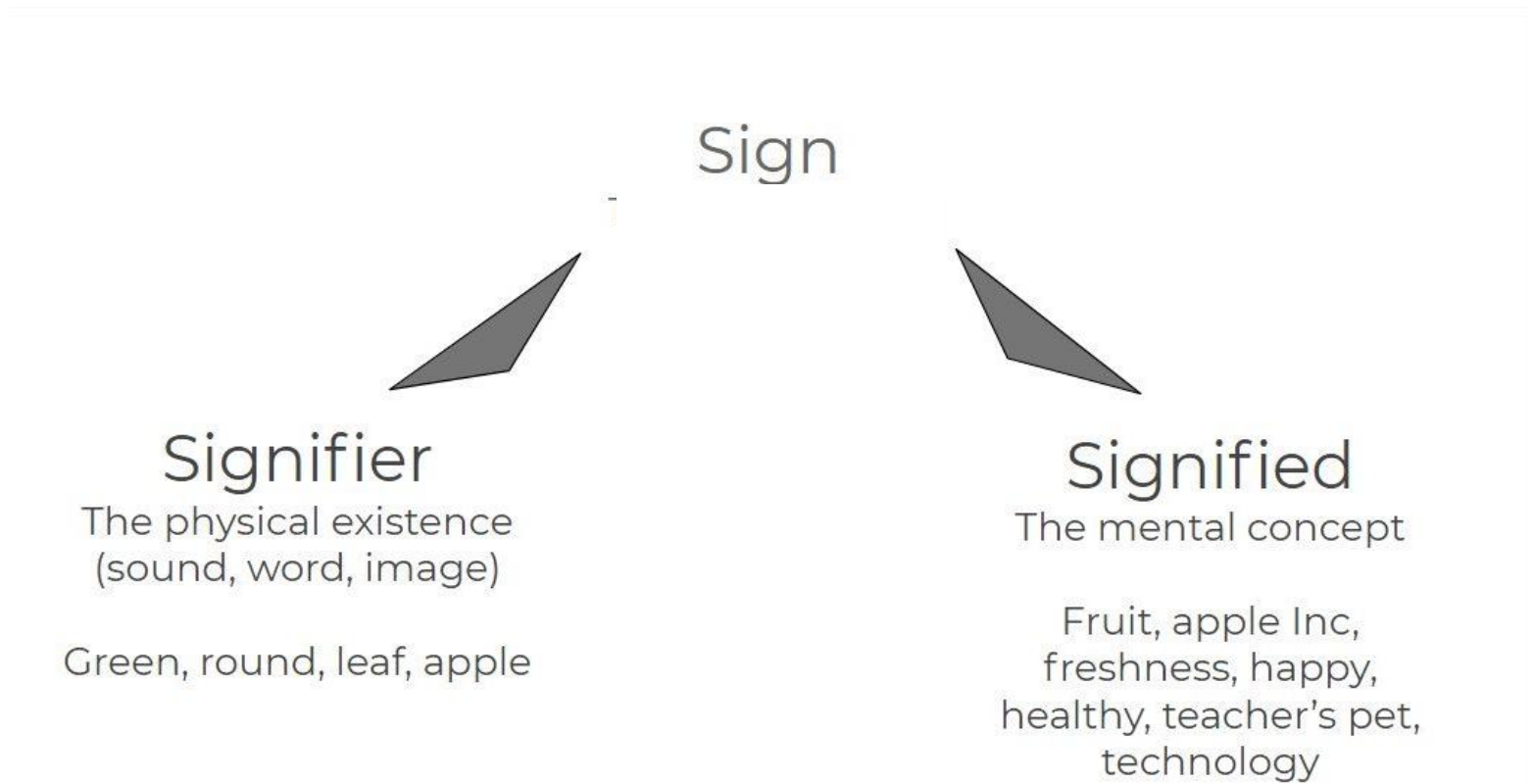
Butler
Cyborg-feminism
Haraway

Rethinking Modernity: Sociology of Media and Culture

Saussure: Course in General Linguistics (1916)







Language, for Saussure, is not a transparent medium that reflects reality, but a structured system of signs, organised through **difference** and **governed by rules that exist independently of individual intention**

Words For Snow

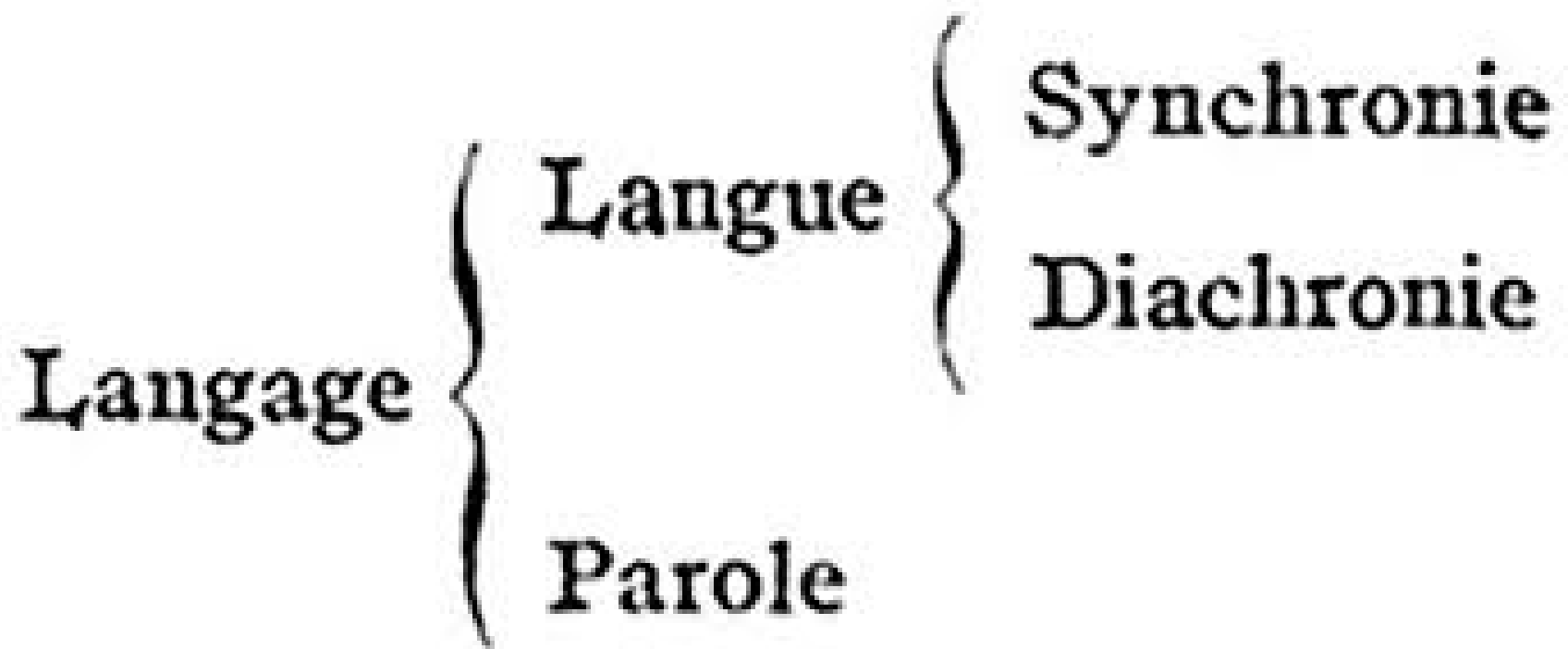
BY ADAM JACOT DE BOINOD

The circumpolar people have many words for snow in all of its forms. Here is a compilation from the Inuit in Greenland and Canada, the Yupik in Eastern Siberia and Aleut in Alaska.

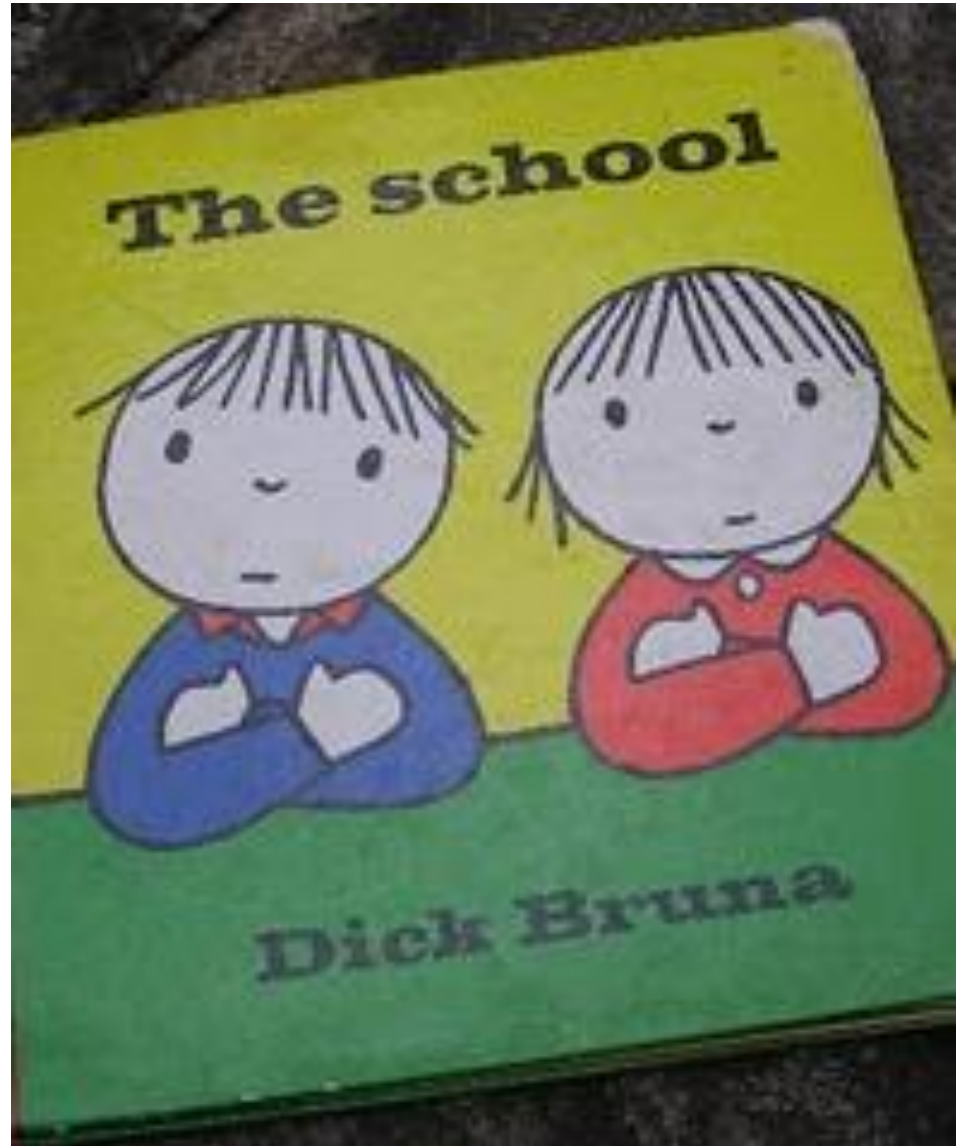
- * Snow – **kaniktshaq**
- * No snow – **aputaitok**
- * To snow – **qanir, qanunge, qanugglir**
- * Snowy weather – **nittaatsug, qannirsug**
- * To get fine snow or rain particles – **kanevcir**
- * First falling – **apingaut**
- * Light falling – **qannialaag**
- * Wet and falling – **natatgo naq**
- * In the air, falling – **qaniit**
- * Feathery clumps of falling snow – **qanipalaat**
- * Air thick with snow – **nittaalaq**
- * Rippled surface of snow – **kaiyuglak**
- * Light, deep enough for walking – **katiksugnik**
- * Fresh without any ice – **kanut**
- * Crusty – **sillik**
- * Soft for travelling – **mauyasiarpok**
- * Soft and deep where snowshoes are

- * Wind-beaten – **upsik**
- * Fresh – **nutaryuk**
- * Packed – **aniu**
- * Sharp – **panar**
- * Crusty that breaks under foot – **karakartanaq**
- * Rotten, slush on sea – **qinuq**
- * Best for building an igloo – **pukaangajuq**
- * Glazed in a thaw – **kiksrukak**
- * Watery – **mangokpok**
- * Firm (the easiest to cut, the warmest, the preferred) – **pukajaw**
- * Loose, newly fallen which cannot be used as it is, but can provide good building material when compacted – **ariloqaq**
- * That a dog eats – **aniusarpok**
- * That can be broken through – **mauya**
- * Floating on water – **qanisqineq**

- * Much on clothes – **aputainnarowok**
- * Crust – **pukak**
- * Cornice, formation about to collapse – **navcaq**
- * On the boughs of trees – **qali**
- * Blown indoors – **sullarniq**
- * Snowdrift overhead and about to fall – **mavsa**
- * Snowdrift that blocks something – **kimaugruk**
- * Smoky drifting snow – **siqoq**
- * Arrow shaped snowdrift – **kalutoganig**
- * Newly drifting snow – **akelrorak**
- * Snowstorm – **pirsuq, pirsirsursuaq, qux**
- * Violent snowstorm – **igadug**
- * Blizzard – **pirta, pirtuk**
- * Avalanche – **sisuuk, aput sisurtuq**
- * To get caught in an avalanche –



Language and
'difference' in
structuralism
:gender



Femininity



- ❖ Obedient
- ❖ Servile
- ❖ Passive
- ❖ Submissive
- ❖ Emotional
- ❖ Sensitive
- ❖ Private sphere
- ❖ Reproductive
- ❖ Child care
- ❖ Domestic labour

Masculinity



- ❖ Manly
- ❖ Virile
- ❖ Muscular
- ❖ Heroic
- ❖ Wise
- ❖ Aggressive
- ❖ Dominant
- ❖ Sexually active
- ❖ Successful
- ❖ Public sphere

Barthes: Mythologies (1957)





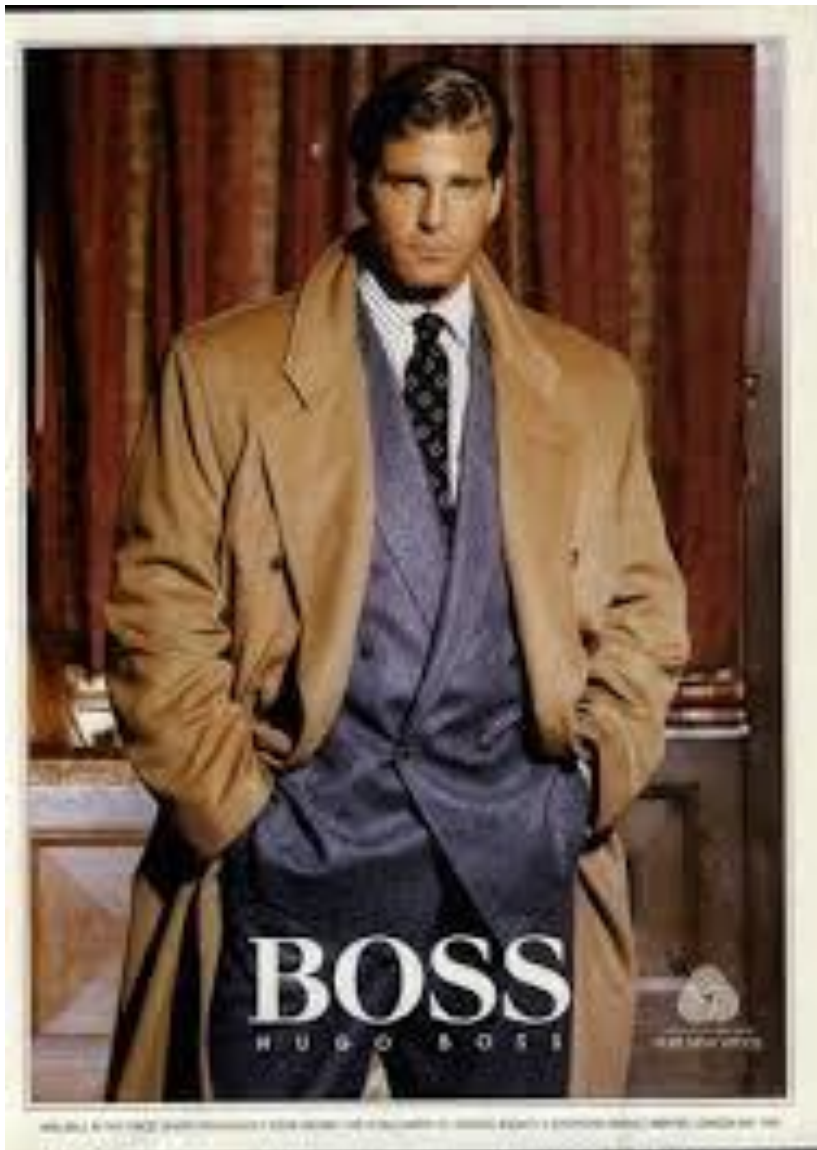
‘Nothing natural’ (Barthes)

- ‘the sign’ not limited to speech / language
- ‘...destroy the idea that signs are natural’



Barthes - Wrestling





- Denotation
- Connotation

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- Denotation
- Connotation



1775

1785

1800

1820

1850

1900

1910



1914

1920

1926

1930

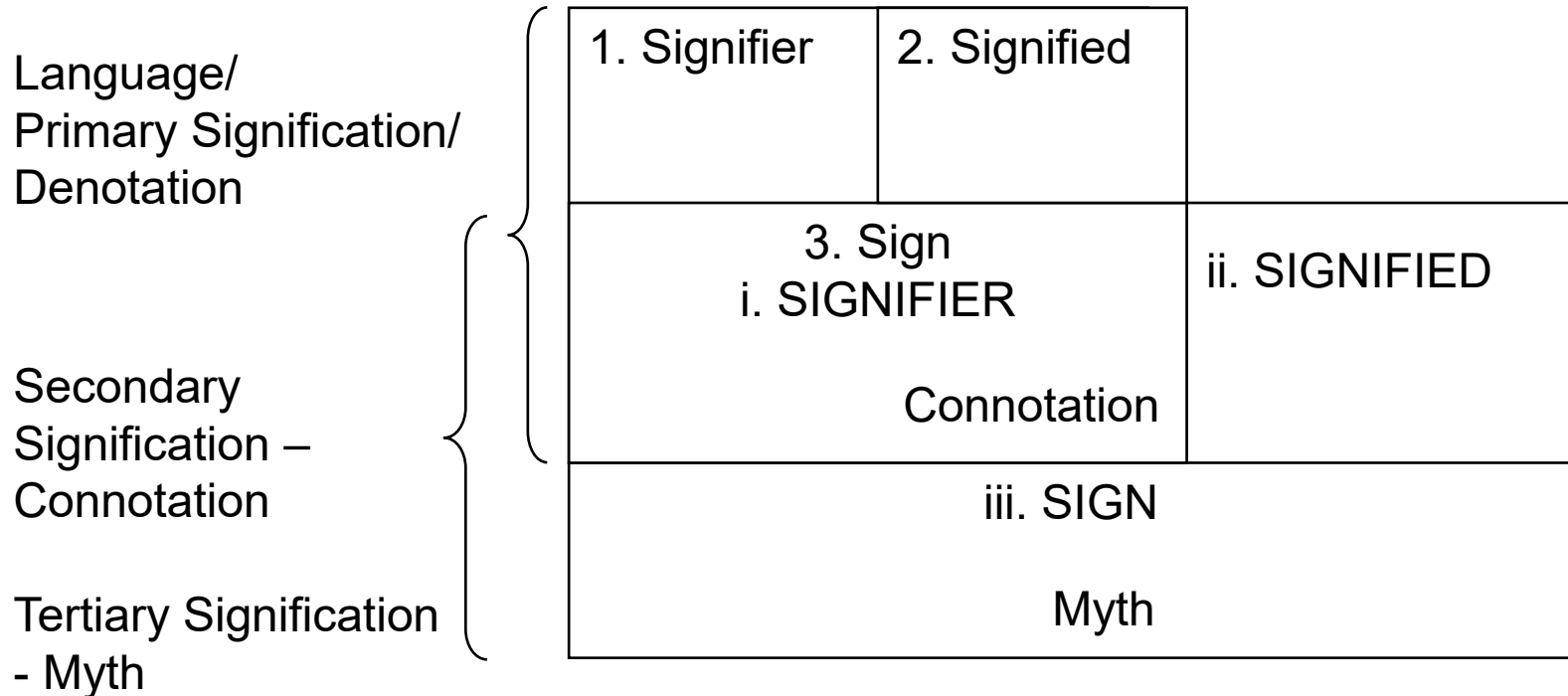
1942

1947

1952



Language into Myth



Denotative meanings of signs are always subject to a second order of connotative meaning and can be solidified as tertiary signification in the form of mythology. As such, Barthes suggested that a dualistic process is at work in communication. A first order system of signs (language) serving a second order system (connotation / mythology).

Barthes - Toys



Barthes – Astrology (Horoscopes)

[illegible]

Friday, January 14, 2011

HOROSCOPES

Capricorn DEC. 22-JAN. 19

You are headed into a time of beginnings. Some changes in life are out of your control, and at other times you have choices. Just because an opportunity comes along, doesn't mean you have to get involved. However, if you overlook something now, it may not come around again for a while, so think carefully about what you want for the future.

Aquarius JAN. 20-FEB. 18

With your highly imaginative, creative mind, and because you're in luck, there are many choices in life. It's important that you don't get lost in too many variables. The best way to succeed is to stick to your goals and not let anything distract you. Stay focused and you'll be successful.

Pisces JAN. 19-FEB. 18

You are in a time of great change. Some of the changes are out of your control, but you can choose how you respond. Stay positive and you'll be successful.



Semiotics / Semiology

- Analysis of signs / symbols / meaning
- Origins in structuralism in terms of signifier / signified, denotation, connotation and mythologies
- Different approaches to semiotics
- Marxist
- Feminist
- Decolonial
- Post-modernist



SEMIOTICS

SEMIOTICS OR SEMIOLOGY IS THE STUDY OF SIGNS SYMBOLS AND SIGNIFICATION. IT IS THE STUDY OF HOW MEANING IS CREATED.

THE FATHERS OF SEMIOTICS

FERDINAND DE SAUSSURE



(1857 - 1913)

One of the two major fathers in the study of signs and sign-using behaviour was Swiss linguist, Ferdinand de Saussure.

Saussure proposed a simple structure of what a sign is, the signifier and the signified.

CHARLES SANDERS PEIRCE



(1839 - 1914)

An American philosopher, Charles Sanders Peirce understood many different principles of semiology.

Pierce proposed that signs could be classified into symbolic, iconic and indexical according to their associations.

ROLAND BARTHES



(1915 - 1980)

A structuralist thinker, Barthes was highly influenced by Saussure and became a "prolific interpreter and leading critic."

In 1976 he was elected chair of literary semiology at the Collège de France and his studies remain relevant today.

SIGNIFIER
- THE FORM THE SIGN TAKES -

SIGNIFIED
- THE CONCEPT IT REPRESENTS

DENOTATION
THE SPECIFIC OR DIRECT MEANING

**SKULL
BONES
HEART**



CONNOTATION
AN ASSOCIATED IDEA OR FEELING

**DEATH
DANGER
LOVE**

SIGN CLASSIFICATIONS

SYMBOLIC



Conventional signs that are culturally specific between the signifier and signified.

ICONIC



Signs where the signifier resembles the signified.

INDEXICAL



Signs where the signifier is caused by the signified, e.g. smoke signifies fire.

SYNTAGM

A SINGLE ELEMENT THAT WHEN ALTERED CAN CHANGE THE OVERALL MEANING.

eat
liked
ravaged
The dog **chased** the cat.

PARADIGM

ELEMENTS THAT CAN BE ALTERED AND STILL RETAIN THE SAME MEANING.



A Rose is a Rose?

- Denotation = A rose is a flower bush in the garden
- Connotation: at the second level of signification, the sign 'roses' becomes a signifier for the consumption of roses on special romantic occasions (e.g. Valentine's day, anniversaries, dates, etc). Not being given roses on such occasions connotes a lack of romance.
- In this instance, myth = romance being commodified; being robbed of its innocent meaning (true love, passion, etc). In other words, the mythical signification is motivated; it is not arbitrary.
- So: 'roses' (object) signify 'passion' (mental concept) = 'passionified' roses (sign: object-plus-meaning).
- Other possible connotations: pain, rugby, England, Labour Party ...

Orders of Signification

Denotative Level (First Order)

- Most obvious level
- Literal meaning

Connotative Level (Second Order)

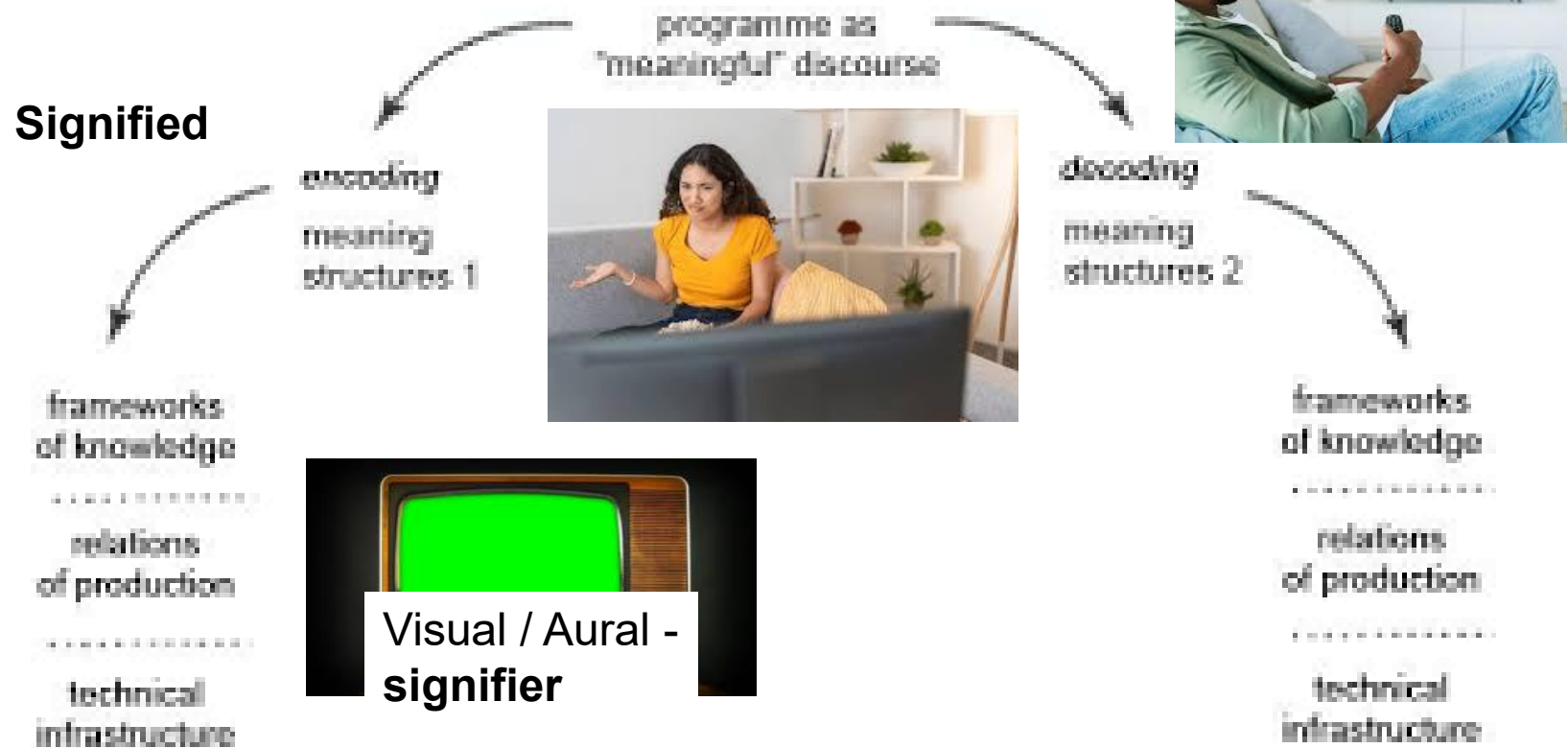
- Cultural level
- Suggested or implied meaning

Mythological Level (Third Order)

- Ideological level
- Worldview that is reinforced by other orders

Hall: building on structuralism?

**Differential
reception of
the audience**





CULTURE

JAMMING

Robbing Myth of Myth: Third-Order Signification

‘Since myth robs language of something, why not rob myth? All that is needed is to use it as the departure point for a third semiological chain, to take its signification as the first term of a second myth’.

Barthes, ‘Myth Today’, p.135.

Orders of Signification

Denotative Level (First Order)

- Most obvious level
- Literal meaning

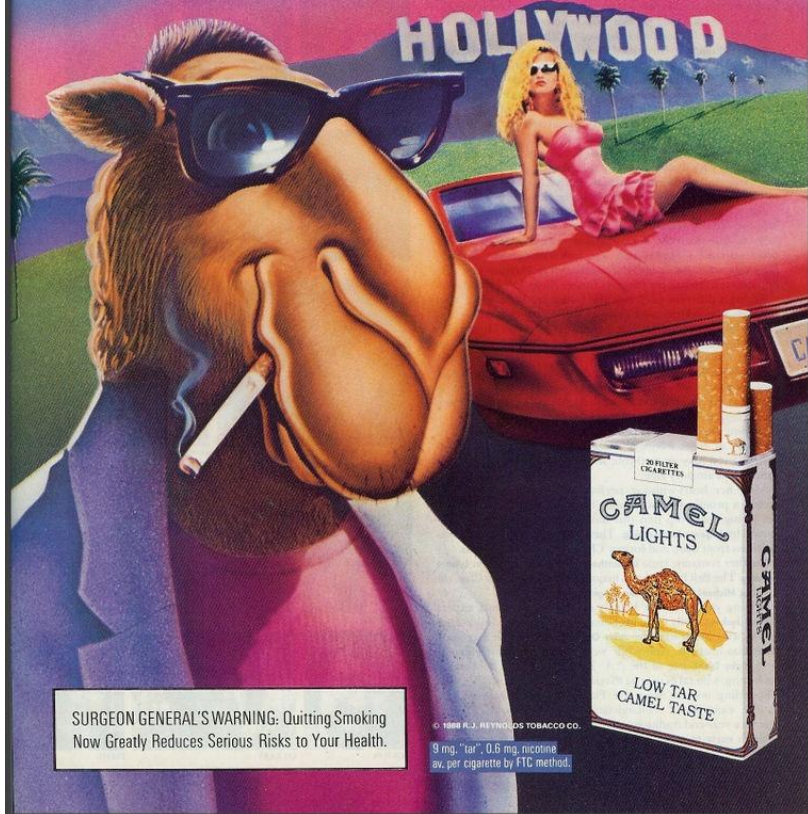
Connotative Level (Second Order)

- Cultural level
- Suggested or implied meaning

Mythological Level (Third Order)

- Ideological level
- Worldview that is reinforced by other orders

Smooth character.



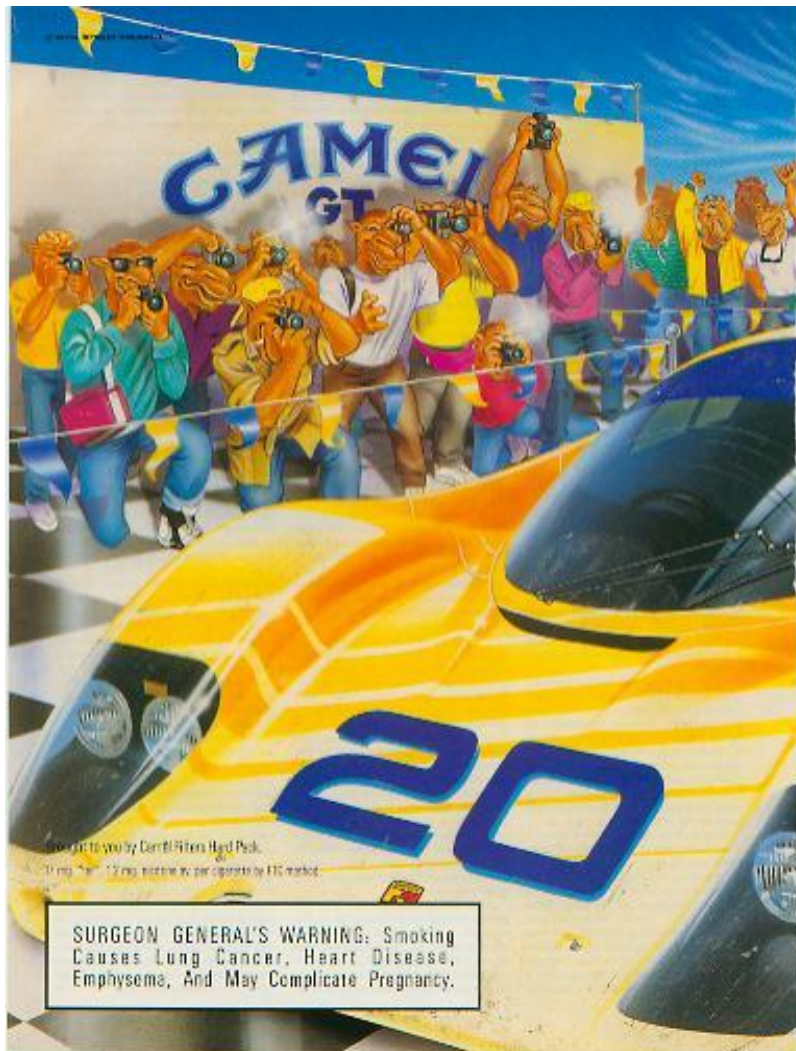
11 mg. "tar", 0.8 mg. nicotine av. per cigarette by FTC method.

SURGEON GENERAL'S WARNING: Cigarette Smoke Contains Carbon Monoxide.

There's something for everyone at Joe's Place.

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LOOK FOR DETAILS

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11 mg "tar," 1.2 mg nicotine av. per cigarette by FTC method.

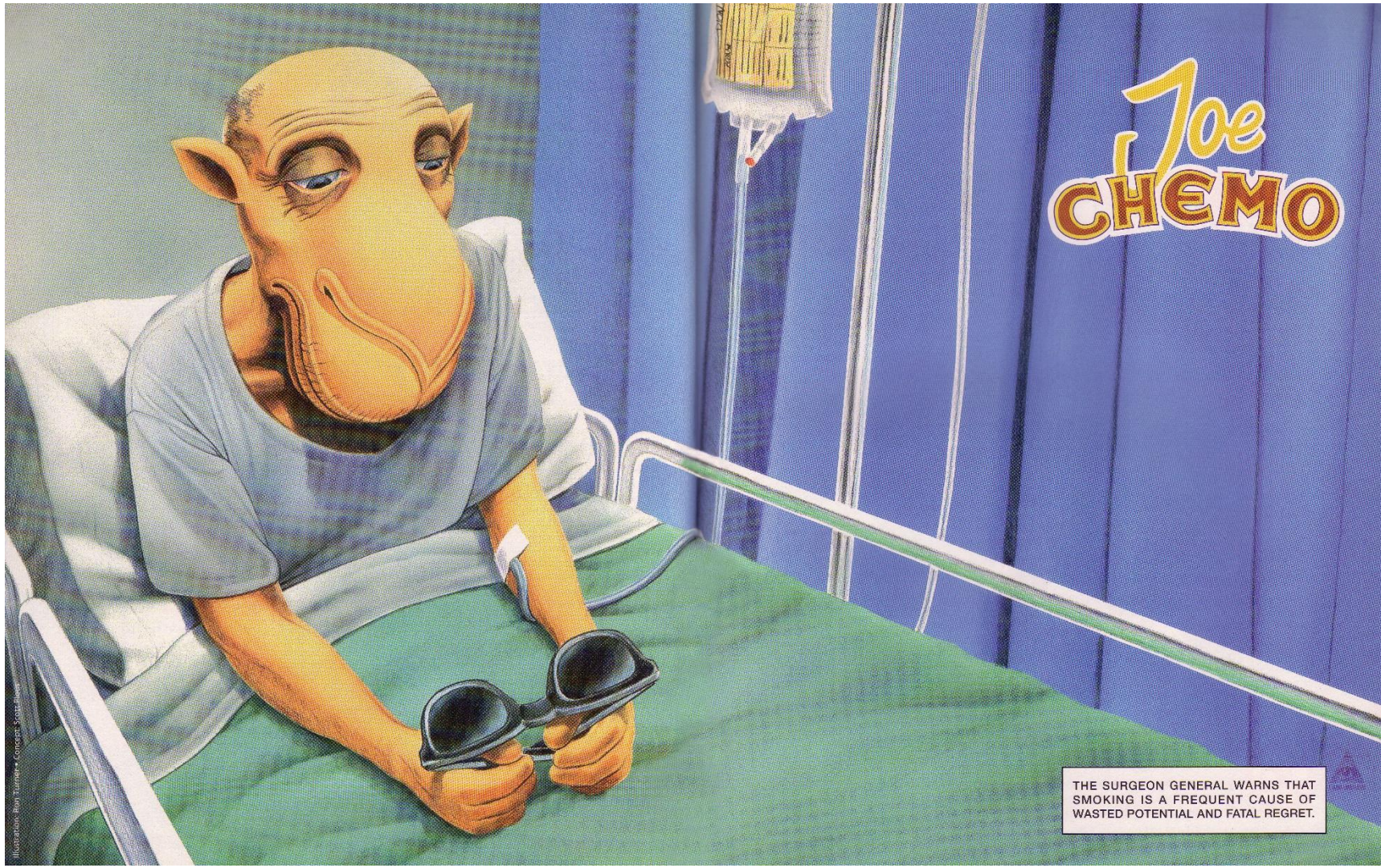
NEW **SPECIAL** **LIGHTS**



SURGEON GENERAL'S WARNING: Cigarette
Smoke Contains Carbon Monoxide.

*Milder. Smoother.
With a character all its own.
One taste will tell you:
this one's something Special.*





Joe CHEMO

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SMOKING IS A FREQUENT CAUSE OF
WASTED POTENTIAL AND FATAL REGRET.

Illustration: Ron Turner • Concept: Scott Allen





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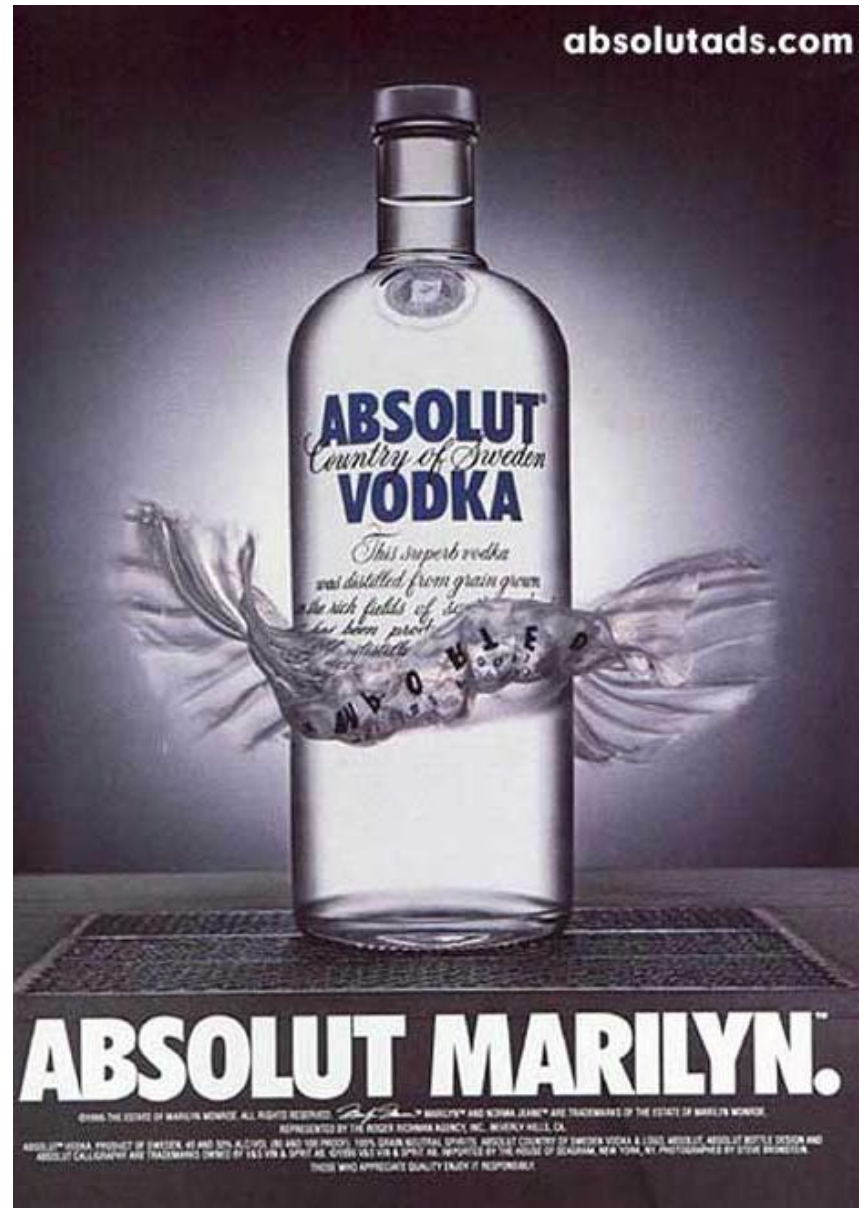
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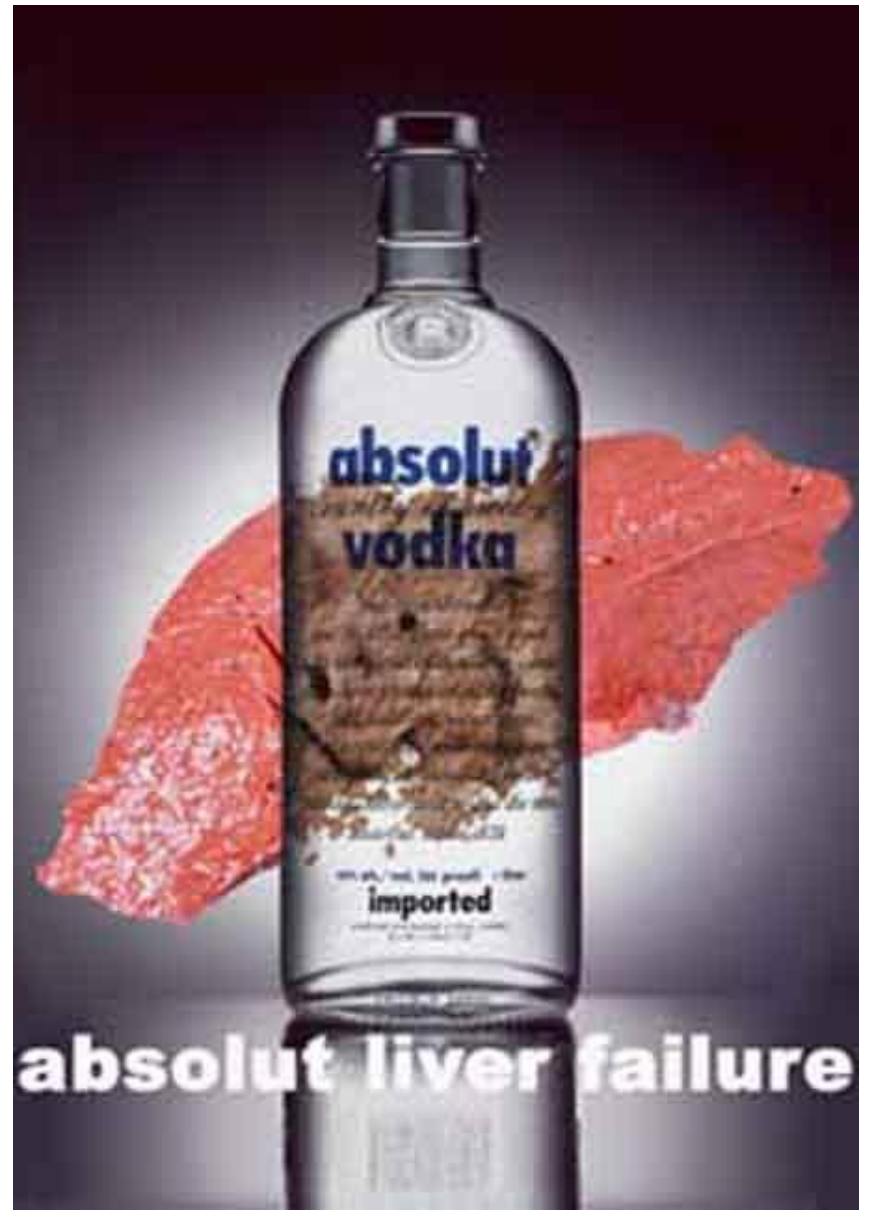
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ABSOLUT
Country of Sweden
VODKA

This superb vodka was distilled from grain grown in the rich fields of southern Sweden. It has been produced at the famous old distilleries near Åhus in accordance with more than 400 years of Swedish tradition. Vodka has been sold under the name Absolut since 1879.

50% 1 LITER
PRODUCED AND BOTTLED IN SWEDEN
BY V&S VIN & SPRIT AB

ABSOLUT IMPOTENCE.

DRINK "PROVOKES THE DESIRE BUT TAKES AWAY THE PERFORMANCE" — WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE



BUT

Third order chains of signification in 'late capitalism'

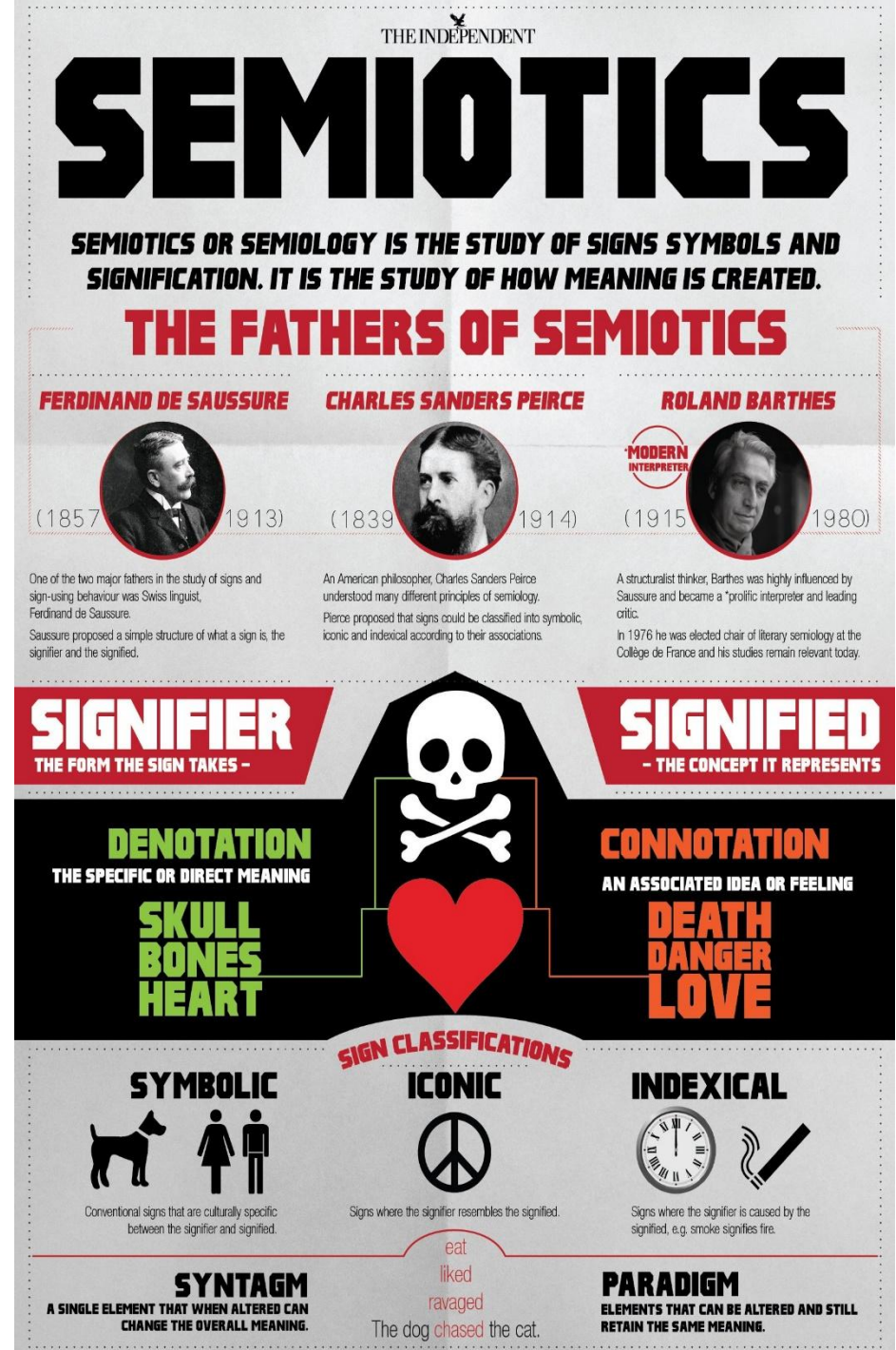


Styles and significations in late capitalism / post-modernity

- **Roadmen**
- **Clean girls**
- **Content creators**
- **Looksmaxxers**
- **Harry Potter Fandom**
- **Gamer**
- Nothing natural but what about further third order significations....knowingness / excess / parody / irony...
- Post-modern culture...

Exercise

- Find a recent print advertisement on-line
- Analyse the advertisement using the techniques of semiology.
- What might be further third order levels of signification? Does the process have an end to it or could it continue infinitely?



Culture and Civilisation Tradition

Arnold /
F.R Leavis
/ Q.D.
Leavis

Marx and Marxism

Marx (Early and Mature)

Frankfurt School
(Adorno / Horkheimer)
Culture Industry
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British Cultural Studies

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Hall

Structuralism

Saussure
Sign / Signifier
Barthes
Mythologies

MODERNISM
'POST'

Intersectionality

Fraser (critique of
Public Sphere)

Reading Week:

1. If you haven't already, read and annotate / summarise the Key readings for each week
2. Using this chart as a basis create a diagram to show the key concepts for each theoretical school